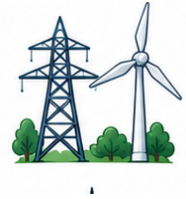


ENGLISH FOR WORK / SEPTEMBER 2026

Energy and Utilities English



Learner workbook

Work with realistic cases, develop your own response, and use the answer section after you have tried the tasks.

PRACTICE THAT TRANSFERS TO WORK

Read a realistic case. Study complete conversations. Find the right language, speak, get feedback, and try again.

Eight lessons | Intermediate to advanced | Independent or classroom study

For utility operations staff, energy project managers, grid planners, field supervisors, regulatory affairs teams, renewable-energy developers, customer operations teams, and infrastructure leaders.

These cases practice communication. Actual equipment, construction, and safety work follows approved procedures and authorized specialist decisions.

All scenarios, figures, and model responses are fictional teaching material. Use invented details in practice.

[Open this course on English Ladder](#)

Your course at a glance

Use the lesson numbers to match this document with the website and the other guides.

01 Grid Reliability and Outage Response

Distinguish completed work from pending work and explain its impact.

02 Safety, Field Work, and Switching

Clarify missing information before responding.

03 Regulatory Affairs and Rate Cases

Explain a useful distinction in plain English.

04 Renewables Integration and Interconnection

Separate observations, assumptions, and conclusions.

05 Asset Management and Maintenance

Compare options using the same criteria and state the tradeoff.

06 Emergency Preparedness and Storm Response

Give a handoff that the receiving person can confirm.

07 Customer Programs and Energy Efficiency

Separate observations, assumptions, and conclusions.

08 Executive Reliability and Investment Updates

Explain a useful distinction in plain English.

Choose your pace

Quick practice: spend 15 minutes reading one conversation and rehearsing one scenario. Full lesson: allow 45-60 minutes for language work, three conversations, two speaking scenarios, and feedback.

Level support

B1 learners can use the frames and a partner. B2 learners can try a response before reading the model. C1 learners can add the harder follow-up and reduce preparation time. These are teaching suggestions, not certified CEFR level ratings.

After practicing: open the AI prompt workshop to choose a vocabulary, grammar, role-play, or new-dialogue activity.

LESSON 01 / READ AND NOTICE

Grid Reliability and Outage Response

Distinguish completed work from pending work and explain its impact.

SITUATION

An outage update lists an affected area but the restoration estimate is still under assessment. A draft message gives a firm time.

1. Understand the situation

Identify two confirmed facts, one missing detail, and the person who needs your response. Do not fill gaps with invented facts.

2. Find the words

reliability - The ability to perform an intended function consistently under stated conditions over time.

feeder - An electrical distribution circuit carrying power to a local service area.

restoration - Returning a disrupted service to operation.

critical customer - A customer whose service needs receive particular operational attention under defined criteria.

3. Notice the language

Lead with the current state, then the important change or open item. Use completed-action language only for completed work. Add a next update point when it is known; do not invent a date to make the message sound complete.

We have completed ...; ... remains open.

As of ..., the status is

The next update will cover

Compare this wording: Everything is progressing well.

LESSON 01 / PRACTICE AND PRODUCE

Give a useful status update

4. Check the language

1. Which sentence says a review is finished?
 - A. The team is completing the review.
 - B. The team plans to complete the review.
 - C. The team has completed the review.
2. Which update distinguishes a plan from a confirmed fact?
 - A. The delivery plan proves that arrival will be Friday.
 - B. Delivery is planned for Friday; the carrier has not confirmed it.
 - C. Delivery is confirmed for Friday because we planned it.

05 • Conversations

The next three pages contain original fictional conversations for this lesson. Each numbered line is one speaking turn. Read the setting before assigning roles.

LESSON 01 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 1 OF 3

Restoration time remains under assessment

Fictional outage-communications exercise: an affected area is identified, but the restoration estimate is still being assessed. No operating instructions are given.

01 • Outage communications officer: The affected area is identified, but the draft gives a firm restoration time we haven't verified.

02 • Customer operations manager: I wanted customers to have something definite. What can we actually confirm right now?

03 • Outage communications officer: We can name the reported area and say restoration timing remains under assessment.

04 • Customer operations manager: Does identifying the feeder mean the cause and repair plan are also established?

05 • Outage communications officer: No. Those are separate questions, and this update doesn't supply verified answers to them.

06 • Customer operations manager: Then I'll remove the firm time and explain that the assessment is continuing.

07 • Outage communications officer: Please keep critical-customer coordination within the approved process rather than making individual restoration promises.

08 • Customer operations manager: Understood. Who will request the next verified status from the responsible operations team?

09 • Outage communications officer: I'll make that request and distinguish any confirmed change from estimates still under review.

10 • Customer operations manager: I'll issue the corrected status without turning an unknown restoration time into a guarantee.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 01 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 2 OF 3

Some streets restored, others still affected

Separate fictional case: service restoration is confirmed for Oak Street, while adjacent Pine Street remains affected; no cause or completion time is supplied.

01 • Community liaison: Oak Street is restored. Can our update say the neighborhood's outage has ended?

02 • Outage coordinator: Not the whole neighborhood. Pine Street remains affected in the current verified status.

03 • Community liaison: I see. The completed restoration applies to Oak Street, not every nearby address.

04 • Outage coordinator: Exactly. Geographic precision matters when customers use the message to plan their next steps.

05 • Community liaison: Should I infer that Pine Street will follow soon because the streets are adjacent?

06 • Outage coordinator: No. Proximity doesn't establish restoration timing, and we don't have a verified estimate here.

07 • Community liaison: I'll name both streets and separate restored service from the area still affected.

08 • Outage coordinator: Good. Also keep any feeder explanation limited to information confirmed by the operations team.

09 • Community liaison: I'll request another status check rather than describe the remaining outage as nearly finished.

10 • Outage coordinator: That gives a useful progress update while preserving the uncertainty about Pine Street's restoration.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 01 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 3 OF 3

Reports received are not repairs completed

Separate fictional service-desk case: twenty outage reports have been logged and grouped for review; field assessment remains pending.

01 • Service desk supervisor: We've logged twenty outage reports. The dashboard says twenty cases handled this morning.

02 • Reliability analyst: Handled is ambiguous. Does it mean logged, assessed, or resolved in this report?

03 • Service desk supervisor: Only logged and grouped. The field assessment is still pending with the responsible team.

04 • Reliability analyst: Then use those completed actions explicitly. Otherwise readers may infer twenty completed restorations.

05 • Service desk supervisor: Could we call them twenty separate outages since each customer submitted a report?

06 • Reliability analyst: Not from that count alone. Several reports may concern the same event; grouping needs verification.

07 • Service desk supervisor: I'll say twenty reports received and grouped, with assessment and restoration status still pending.

08 • Reliability analyst: Good. Keep report volume separate from the reliability measures used for verified outage events.

09 • Service desk supervisor: I'll ask the operations liaison for the assessment update and avoid announcing a completion time.

10 • Reliability analyst: That makes the dashboard more informative without claiming work that the records don't establish.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 01 / 06 • SAY IT

Two scenarios to practice

Use only the supplied facts. Prepare for two minutes, speak for one minute, then respond to a follow-up. Switch roles and repeat. For solo study, speak both roles aloud.

Scenario 1 | Grid Reliability and Outage Response

An outage update lists an affected area but the restoration estimate is still under assessment. A draft message gives a firm time.

Prepare for two minutes. Speak for 45-60 seconds using the case facts, then respond to your partner's question. Switch roles and repeat without reading the model response.

Partner: You need to brief someone who has only one minute. Ask what is complete, what is open, and which open item affects the next action.

Second round: The listener asks you to reduce the update to two sentences. Preserve the most important completed and pending items.

Model for scenario 1: The affected area is identified, but restoration timing is still being assessed. I'll state what is confirmed and when customers should expect the next update rather than promise an unverified time.

Scenario 2 | The status map has not refreshed

A fictional operations update confirms restoration in Zone A, but the public map still displays an outage there. Zone B remains affected. Discuss the current status and who checks the map update; no restoration time is supplied for Zone B.

Role A: Communications coordinator: separate the verified service status from the display discrepancy.

Role B: Customer-service lead: ask what staff should say about each zone.

Possible opening: Zone A is confirmed restored, but the map has not reflected that update; Zone B remains affected.

Success checks

- Preserve the different zone statuses.
- Identify the map discrepancy separately.
- Assign a display-status check without promising Zone B restoration.

Add a complication: A colleague wants to announce that both zones are restored to simplify the message.

Check: facts accurate | meaning clear | tone appropriate | next action or question explicit

Continue scenario 1 with an AI partner.

LESSON 02 / READ AND NOTICE

Safety, Field Work, and Switching

Clarify missing information before responding.

SITUATION

During a language simulation, two documents use different equipment identifiers for a field task. Only authorized procedures govern the actual work.

1. Understand the situation

Identify two confirmed facts, one missing detail, and the person who needs your response. Do not fill gaps with invented facts.

2. Find the words

switching order - An authorized sequence of electrical system operations; actual work must follow the approved procedure.

lockout - An authorized process using isolation and locking measures to control hazardous energy.

clearance - Formal permission or confirmation that a required review has been completed; the meaning depends on the task.

energize - To supply electrical energy to equipment or a circuit under the relevant authorized procedure.

3. Notice the language

Name the exact word, fact, or requirement you need clarified. Ask one focused question at a time. Repeat your understanding and give the other person a chance to correct it.

When you say ..., do you mean ...?

Could you clarify which ...?

So, my understanding is Is that right?

Compare this wording: Could you explain what does this mean?

LESSON 02 / PRACTICE AND PRODUCE

Ask a precise question

4. Check the language

1. Which indirect question has the usual word order?
 - A. Could you confirm when starts the review?
 - B. Could you confirm when the review starts?
 - C. Could you confirm when does the review start?
2. Someone says the report is 'ready.' Which question best clarifies its approval status?
 - A. Has the report been approved, or is it ready for review?
 - B. Can you send the report to me this afternoon?
 - C. Who will present the report at the meeting?

05 • Conversations

The next three pages contain original fictional conversations for this lesson. Each numbered line is one speaking turn. Read the setting before assigning roles.

LESSON 02 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 1 OF 3

Two identifiers for the same field request

Fictional language simulation: a field request names equipment E12 while its accompanying document names E21. Actual work follows authorized procedures; no switching steps are provided.

01 • Field work coordinator: The request names E12, but the accompanying document names E21. Could you clarify the mismatch?

02 • Operations liaison: I can't identify the correct equipment from those conflicting documents. We need authorized verification.

03 • Field work coordinator: Should I assume it's a typing error and change the identifier that looks less familiar?

04 • Operations liaison: No. Familiarity isn't verification, especially in a switching-order or clearance-related record.

05 • Field work coordinator: I'll request the current approved references and identify both conflicting values without choosing one.

06 • Operations liaison: Please do. Keep any actual work subject to the applicable safety and authorization process.

07 • Field work coordinator: Does receiving a corrected document alone authorize the team to energize the equipment?

08 • Operations liaison: We can't infer that. Document clarification is not a substitute for the required operational authorization.

09 • Field work coordinator: Then our update will say identifier conflict unresolved and verification requested from the responsible authority.

10 • Operations liaison: Correct. This conversation clarifies information; it does not provide lockout, switching, or energizing instructions.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 02 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 2 OF 3

Which document does released refer to?

Separate fictional administrative exercise: an email says released without identifying whether it refers to a document or an operational clearance.

01 • Document coordinator: Your email says released. Could you clarify whether you mean a document issue or a clearance status?

02 • Field planning liaison: I meant the planning document was issued, not that an operational clearance had changed.

03 • Document coordinator: Thank you. That difference needs to appear in the message before I pass it on.

04 • Field planning liaison: I'll revise it to say planning document issued and include its verified reference.

05 • Document coordinator: Does the message establish anything about lockout status or permission to begin the field task?

06 • Field planning liaison: No. Those matters follow the authorized process and are not established by this administrative update.

07 • Document coordinator: I'll ask recipients to repeat the document status if the earlier word caused confusion.

08 • Field planning liaison: Good. We should also preserve the correction so the ambiguous version isn't treated as current.

09 • Document coordinator: I'll distribute the clarified wording through the normal document channel without adding operating instructions.

10 • Field planning liaison: Agreed. Clear language should prevent an administrative milestone being mistaken for operational authority.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 02 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 3 OF 3

A copied order lacks its revision

Separate fictional coordination exercise: a copied switching-order cover sheet has no revision identifier; the complete approved order is unavailable in the conversation.

01 • Scheduling assistant: This copied cover sheet has no revision identifier. Which approved version should the coordination record cite?

02 • Authorized-work liaison: We need document control to verify that. The copy alone doesn't establish the current switching order.

03 • Scheduling assistant: The date looks recent. Would it be reasonable to label it current for the meeting?

04 • Authorized-work liaison: No. A recent date doesn't prove approval or replace a verified revision reference.

05 • Scheduling assistant: I'll request the complete current reference and ask why the identifier is missing from this copy.

06 • Authorized-work liaison: Keep the request neutral. We don't yet know whether the omission occurred during copying or elsewhere.

07 • Scheduling assistant: Should the schedule show the field task as cleared while we wait for the document?

08 • Authorized-work liaison: That status isn't established here. Use the applicable authorization process and keep the document question open.

09 • Scheduling assistant: I'll report the missing revision, verification request, and responsible liaison without inferring clearance.

10 • Authorized-work liaison: Good. The exercise concerns accurate coordination, not instructions to operate or energize equipment.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 02 / 06 • SAY IT

Two scenarios to practice

Use only the supplied facts. Prepare for two minutes, speak for one minute, then respond to a follow-up. Switch roles and repeat. For solo study, speak both roles aloud.

Scenario 1 | Safety, Field Work, and Switching

During a language simulation, two documents use different equipment identifiers for a field task. Only authorized procedures govern the actual work.

Prepare for two minutes. Speak for 45-60 seconds using the case facts, then respond to your partner's question. Switch roles and repeat without reading the model response.

Partner: You need to know exactly what information is missing. Give one answer only after your partner asks a focused question; then ask them to confirm their understanding.

Second round: The other person uses an ambiguous word such as 'ready', 'approved', or 'urgent'. Clarify it before continuing.

Model for scenario 1: The equipment identifiers do not match. Please have the authorized team resolve the discrepancy using the approved procedure. I will repeat the identifiers clearly to confirm that we are discussing the same equipment.

Scenario 2 | A site nickname obscures the reference

In a fictional field-planning exercise, a message refers to the old yard unit, but the formal equipment identifier is absent. No operational status is known. Ask for the verified reference rather than interpreting the nickname.

Role A: Planning coordinator: request the formal identifier and approved source.

Role B: Operations liaison: acknowledge the missing information and seek authorized clarification.

Possible opening: Could you confirm the formal equipment identifier behind the phrase old yard unit?

Success checks

- Distinguish a nickname from a verified identifier.
- Request the approved source.
- Avoid giving switching, lockout, or clearance instructions.

Add a complication: A colleague offers a remembered identifier but cannot verify it.

Check: facts accurate | meaning clear | tone appropriate | next action or question explicit

Continue scenario 1 with an AI partner.

LESSON 03 / READ AND NOTICE

Regulatory Affairs and Rate Cases

Explain a useful distinction in plain English.

SITUATION

A customer sees a proposed rate adjustment and assumes it is already in effect. The notice describes a proposal under review.

1. Understand the situation

Identify two confirmed facts, one missing detail, and the person who needs your response. Do not fill gaps with invented facts.

2. Find the words

rate case - A regulatory proceeding concerning a utility's proposed rates and supporting basis.

tariff - A published schedule of regulated service rates and conditions; in trade, a tax on specified goods.

prudence - Reasonableness of a utility decision or expenditure as assessed under the relevant regulatory standard.

customer impact - The effect an event or decision has on people using a product or service.

3. Notice the language

Start with the reader's question. Explain one unfamiliar term with familiar words, then give a relevant example or contrast. Check understanding without asking only 'Do you understand?'.

In this context, ... means

The difference is that

How would you explain that distinction to a colleague?

Compare this wording: We need to operationalize the implementation.

LESSON 03 / PRACTICE AND PRODUCE

Make a complex point clear

4. Check the language

1. Which sentence explains 'backlog' rather than repeating it?
 - A. The backlog is the work still waiting to be completed.
 - B. The backlog is the work completed during the last period.
 - C. The backlog is the maximum work the team can finish in a period.
2. Which follow-up best checks whether your explanation was clear?
 - A. Would you like me to repeat the explanation?
 - B. Was the explanation detailed enough for you?
 - C. How would you describe the next step in your own words?

05 • Conversations

The next three pages contain original fictional conversations for this lesson. Each numbered line is one speaking turn. Read the setting before assigning roles.

LESSON 03 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 1 OF 3

A proposed adjustment is not today's tariff

Fictional rate-case communication: a public notice describes a proposed adjustment under review; no approval or effective date is supplied.

01 • Business customer liaison: A customer thinks the proposed rate adjustment already applies to their current bill.

02 • Regulatory communications officer: The notice describes a proposal under review, not an approved change currently in effect.

03 • Business customer liaison: How can I explain a rate case without repeating technical language from the notice?

04 • Regulatory communications officer: Describe it as a review of a requested rate change, with an outcome not yet established.

05 • Business customer liaison: So the proposed tariff wording isn't automatically the schedule used for today's charges?

06 • Regulatory communications officer: Correct. We need the applicable current tariff and account details to discuss an actual bill.

07 • Business customer liaison: Could I reassure the customer that the proposal will certainly be rejected or reduced?

08 • Regulatory communications officer: No. That would predict the review's outcome without evidence and confuse customer impact further.

09 • Business customer liaison: I'll distinguish proposed rates from current charges and refer the bill question for a proper check.

10 • Regulatory communications officer: Good. Keep any effective-date statement limited to what the verified documents actually establish.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 03 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 2 OF 3

A review question is not a finding of imprudence

Separate fictional regulatory briefing: reviewers request more support for a proposed cost; no conclusion about prudence has been issued.

01 • Finance liaison: The reviewers asked for more support. Does that mean they found our spending imprudent?

02 • Regulatory analyst: Not from this request. They are asking for evidence, not stating a final conclusion.

03 • Finance liaison: Could you explain prudence in plain language for the project team attending our briefing?

04 • Regulatory analyst: In this discussion, it concerns whether spending decisions were reasonable under the relevant review framework.

05 • Finance liaison: Then a question about a cost isn't the same as a decision rejecting it.

06 • Regulatory analyst: Exactly. We should describe the requested support and avoid predicting the rate-case outcome.

07 • Finance liaison: Would saying the cost is definitely recoverable be equally unsupported at this stage?

08 • Regulatory analyst: Yes. Neither acceptance nor rejection has been established by the information request we're discussing.

09 • Finance liaison: I'll ask the cost owner for the supporting records and label the issue under review.

10 • Regulatory analyst: That preserves the distinction between a review step and a determination with possible customer impact.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 03 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 3 OF 3

An average impact is not every customer's bill

Separate fictional notice: an illustrative proposal shows an average bill increase of 6 units for a defined sample; individual account effects are not calculated.

01 • Customer programs manager: The illustration says six units more. Can we tell every customer their bill rises by six?

02 • Rate communications analyst: No. That's an average for the defined sample, not a calculation for every account.

03 • Customer programs manager: What familiar explanation would help staff distinguish that average from an individual bill estimate?

04 • Rate communications analyst: An average summarizes the sample; individual charges depend on the applicable terms and account information.

05 • Customer programs manager: And because this is a proposal, the illustration doesn't establish an approved tariff change either?

06 • Rate communications analyst: Correct. Both the proposal status and the sample boundary belong in our explanation.

07 • Customer programs manager: Could we call six units the maximum impact to make the notice sound less concerning?

08 • Rate communications analyst: The figure isn't a maximum. That wording would add a claim the supplied analysis doesn't support.

09 • Customer programs manager: I'll explain the example as illustrative and route individual questions to the proper billing review.

10 • Rate communications analyst: Good. Clear language should retain the distinction, not simplify it into an inaccurate guarantee.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 03 / 06 • SAY IT

Two scenarios to practice

Use only the supplied facts. Prepare for two minutes, speak for one minute, then respond to a follow-up. Switch roles and repeat. For solo study, speak both roles aloud.

Scenario 1 | Regulatory Affairs and Rate Cases

A customer sees a proposed rate adjustment and assumes it is already in effect. The notice describes a proposal under review.

Prepare for two minutes. Speak for 45-60 seconds using the case facts, then respond to your partner's question. Switch roles and repeat without reading the model response.

Partner: You are unfamiliar with one technical term in the case. Ask for a plain-English explanation and then paraphrase it. Do not pretend to understand a term you cannot explain.

Second round: Your listener is new to this field. Replace two specialist expressions with clear explanations without changing the meaning.

Model for scenario 1: The notice describes a proposed adjustment, not a change already in effect. Let me show you the stated review process and where to find the current applicable tariff information.

Scenario 2 | A hearing date is not an effective date

A fictional rate-case notice lists a hearing on October 12 but gives no approval or effective date. A business association assumes new charges begin that day. Explain the distinction in a call.

Role A: Regulatory liaison: explain what the hearing date establishes and what it does not.

Role B: Association coordinator: paraphrase the distinction and ask where verified status updates will come from.

Possible opening: October 12 is the hearing date in this notice, not a stated date for new charges to begin.

Success checks

- Distinguish a review event from an effective date.
- Avoid predicting the decision.
- Agree to use verified notices for future status statements.

Add a complication: The coordinator asks whether approval immediately after the hearing is guaranteed.

Check: facts accurate | meaning clear | tone appropriate | next action or question explicit

Continue scenario 1 with an AI partner.

LESSON 04 / READ AND NOTICE

Renewables Integration and Interconnection

Separate observations, assumptions, and conclusions.

SITUATION

A project team describes an interconnection application as an approved connection. Technical and administrative reviews are still open.

1. Understand the situation

Identify two confirmed facts, one missing detail, and the person who needs your response. Do not fill gaps with invented facts.

2. Find the words

interconnection - A connection between an electricity-generating or storage facility and a power system.

capacity - Available people, assets, time, space, or system throughput for a given workload.

curtailment - A reduction in electricity generation or use required by operating conditions or instructions.

queue - A list of items or people waiting for processing or service.

3. Notice the language

Say what the evidence shows, identify what is still unknown, and limit the conclusion to that evidence. Words such as 'may', 'suggests', and 'in this sample' are useful when the uncertainty is real. Do not soften an urgent, verified safety concern.

The available evidence shows

This may indicate ..., but

We have not yet established whether

Compare this wording: The pilot proves this will work everywhere.

LESSON 04 / PRACTICE AND PRODUCE

Match certainty to evidence

4. Check the language

1. Which sentence preserves uncertainty about an unconfirmed cause?
 - A. The change must have caused the delay.
 - B. The change definitely caused the delay.
 - C. The change may have contributed to the delay.
2. A result comes from a small pilot in one location. Which phrase accurately limits the claim?
 - A. Across the service, the observed result was ...
 - B. In this pilot, the observed result was ...
 - C. In similar locations, we can now expect the same result ...

05 • Conversations

The next three pages contain original fictional conversations for this lesson. Each numbered line is one speaking turn. Read the setting before assigning roles.

LESSON 04 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 1 OF 3

An application is not an approved connection

Fictional renewable-project review: an interconnection application is submitted, while technical and administrative reviews remain open.

01 • Project developer: Our slide says approved connection because the interconnection application has entered the queue.

02 • Interconnection coordinator: Queue entry establishes application progress, not approval. Technical and administrative reviews are still open.

03 • Project developer: Then what milestone can we accurately communicate to the investment team this afternoon?

04 • Interconnection coordinator: Say the application is submitted and under review, with connection approval not yet established.

05 • Project developer: Does the requested capacity establish how much the project will be allowed to export?

06 • Interconnection coordinator: Not from the application alone. We haven't received the authorized outcome or applicable conditions.

07 • Project developer: Should we also avoid assuming that no curtailment conditions will apply to this project?

08 • Interconnection coordinator: Yes. The supplied information doesn't establish those conditions, so keep them unresolved.

09 • Project developer: I'll revise the milestone and list the review questions rather than imply a granted connection.

10 • Interconnection coordinator: Good. The next update can report verified decisions without turning an application into operating permission.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 04 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 2 OF 3

A preliminary study does not settle capacity

Separate fictional case: a preliminary interconnection study models one project configuration; a proposed larger configuration has not been studied.

01 • Renewables project manager: The preliminary study looks favorable. Can we use it to support the larger configuration too?

02 • Grid studies liaison: It covers the original configuration only. The increased capacity hasn't been assessed in that study.

03 • Renewables project manager: The site is unchanged, so I thought the result would transfer without further questions.

04 • Grid studies liaison: An unchanged site doesn't establish that different capacity has the same assessed effects.

05 • Renewables project manager: Then our statement should name the studied configuration and keep the larger proposal unassessed.

06 • Grid studies liaison: Exactly. Also retain preliminary status instead of presenting the study as a final interconnection approval.

07 • Renewables project manager: Could we ask the responsible team what review the revised application would require?

08 • Grid studies liaison: Yes. That's a bounded request, without assuming queue treatment, technical acceptance, or operating conditions.

09 • Renewables project manager: I'll separate the existing study result from the proposal and request that clarification.

10 • Grid studies liaison: Good. That keeps the evidence useful without extending it beyond the configuration actually reviewed.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 04 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 3 OF 3

A queue position is not a guaranteed date

Separate fictional project meeting: a queue record lists a project position but no confirmed connection date; the team wants to announce energization timing.

01 • Development coordinator: We have a queue position now. Can the announcement give a definite connection date?

02 • Interconnection analyst: The queue record doesn't supply one. A position isn't evidence of a guaranteed completion date.

03 • Development coordinator: Could we estimate the date from the project immediately ahead of ours in the list?

04 • Interconnection analyst: We haven't established comparable review requirements or conditions, so that comparison wouldn't confirm our timing.

05 • Development coordinator: What positive progress can we report without giving the impression that nothing has happened?

06 • Interconnection analyst: Report the recorded queue milestone and clearly state that reviews and connection timing remain unresolved.

07 • Development coordinator: Should we describe the requested capacity as reserved for us until those reviews finish?

08 • Interconnection analyst: Not unless the relevant verified documents establish that status. This queue entry doesn't do so here.

09 • Development coordinator: I'll remove the energization date and ask the responsible team what timing information is available.

10 • Interconnection analyst: That is accurate progress reporting, not a promise of technical approval or permission to connect.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 04 / 06 • SAY IT

Two scenarios to practice

Use only the supplied facts. Prepare for two minutes, speak for one minute, then respond to a follow-up. Switch roles and repeat. For solo study, speak both roles aloud.

Scenario 1 | Renewables Integration and Interconnection

A project team describes an interconnection application as an approved connection. Technical and administrative reviews are still open.

Prepare for two minutes. Speak for 45-60 seconds using the case facts, then respond to your partner's question. Switch roles and repeat without reading the model response.

Partner: You need to tell a colleague what is known. Ask which part is confirmed and which part is an assumption. Challenge one statement that sounds more certain than the case supports.

Second round: Someone asks for a yes-or-no answer when the evidence supports only a qualified answer. Be concise while preserving the uncertainty.

Model for scenario 1: The application has been submitted, but the reviews are still open. I'll describe the current stage and remaining steps without implying that connection has already been authorized.

Scenario 2 | A fee receipt is mistaken for technical acceptance

A fictional developer has a receipt for an application payment but no technical review result. The project slide says technical acceptance complete. Discuss a corrected claim and the next status request.

Role A: Project analyst: explain what the receipt proves and identify the missing review result.

Role B: Development manager: challenge whether payment can reasonably be called approval.

Possible opening: The receipt confirms payment, but it doesn't establish technical acceptance of the interconnection application.

Success checks

- Separate payment from technical review.
- Retain the unknown approval status.
- Agree a request for the authorized review update.

Add a complication: The manager asks to keep approved on the slide because investors prefer a shorter label.

Check: facts accurate | meaning clear | tone appropriate | next action or question explicit

Continue scenario 1 with an AI partner.

LESSON 05 / READ AND NOTICE

Asset Management and Maintenance

Compare options using the same criteria and state the tradeoff.

SITUATION

Two asset options have different purchase prices and maintenance needs. A budget slide compares only the purchase price.

1. Understand the situation

Identify two confirmed facts, one missing detail, and the person who needs your response. Do not fill gaps with invented facts.

2. Find the words

asset management - Planning and managing assets through their useful lives to support organizational objectives.

condition assessment - An evaluation of an asset's current physical or operating state.

lifecycle cost - The estimated costs of acquiring, operating, maintaining, and retiring an asset.

failure rate - The frequency of failures relative to a defined operating time or population.

3. Notice the language

Use the same time period, scope, and measurement basis for both options. Explain a difference with 'whereas' or 'while'. State what improves and what is given up; do not hide the weaker side of a recommendation.

Both options ..., but

Option A ..., whereas option B

The comparison depends on

Compare this wording: This option is more better.

LESSON 05 / PRACTICE AND PRODUCE

Explain a fair comparison

4. Check the language

1. Which sentence expresses a clear contrast?
 - A. Option A is faster, so option B costs less.
 - B. Option A is faster, whereas option B costs less.
 - C. Option A is faster because option B costs less.
2. A rate increases from 6% to 7%. What is the absolute difference?
 - A. An increase of one percentage point.
 - B. An increase of one percent relative to the original rate.
 - C. An increase of seven percentage points.

05 • Conversations

The next three pages contain original fictional conversations for this lesson. Each numbered line is one speaking turn. Read the setting before assigning roles.

LESSON 05 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 1 OF 3

Purchase price leaves out maintenance

Fictional asset comparison: option A costs 40 units plus an estimated 12 maintenance units over five years; B costs 48 plus 3. Other costs and performance are unassessed.

01 • Budget manager: Option A costs forty and B costs forty-eight. Why isn't A clearly the cheaper asset?

02 • Asset analyst: For the same five-year period, estimated maintenance is twelve for A and three for B.

03 • Budget manager: So the listed purchase-plus-maintenance totals are fifty-two and fifty-one, respectively, under these assumptions.

04 • Asset analyst: Correct, but those aren't complete lifecycle costs. We haven't assessed other costs or performance.

05 • Budget manager: Can we still recommend B solely because its listed total is one unit lower?

06 • Asset analyst: That difference alone isn't a full decision basis. We need comparable condition and performance information.

07 • Budget manager: What tradeoff should the slide show while we obtain the missing assessment?

08 • Asset analyst: A has lower initial cost; B has lower estimated maintenance over the same stated period.

09 • Budget manager: I'll use identical categories and label missing costs, rather than call either total comprehensive.

10 • Asset analyst: Good. The comparison can inform asset management without pretending our incomplete estimates settle the choice.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 05 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 2 OF 3

Different observation periods distort failure comparisons

Separate fictional asset review: asset group A has two failures over one year; group B has three over three years. Group sizes and operating exposure are not supplied.

01 • Maintenance manager: Group B had three failures and A had two. Should we call B less reliable?

02 • Condition analyst: The observation periods differ, and we don't have comparable group sizes or operating exposure.

03 • Maintenance manager: Could I simply divide B's count by three and use that as a failure rate?

04 • Condition analyst: That gives a yearly count, but still doesn't resolve the missing exposure and population information.

05 • Maintenance manager: Then we need the same comparison criteria before making an asset-management recommendation from these figures.

06 • Condition analyst: Yes. Include time, population, relevant use, and condition assessment alongside the recorded events.

07 • Maintenance manager: The budget team wants a quick choice. Can we at least rank the groups provisionally?

08 • Condition analyst: We can show the raw observations with their limitations, but shouldn't present an unsupported reliability ranking.

09 • Maintenance manager: I'll request the missing denominators and describe why the present counts aren't directly comparable.

10 • Condition analyst: That preserves the evidence and prevents an apparent difference becoming an unjustified investment conclusion.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 05 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 3 OF 3

Remote monitoring versus inspection visits

Separate fictional planning comparison: two proposed asset-monitoring packages cover the same twelve assets; A has more visits, B has remote reports. Costs and suitability await qualified review.

01 • Asset program coordinator: Package A includes more site visits; B provides remote reports for the same twelve assets.

02 • Maintenance planning lead: Which criteria will we use to compare them beyond the number of visits included?

03 • Asset program coordinator: Coverage, information quality, cost, and required follow-up should be assessed consistently for both packages.

04 • Maintenance planning lead: Can we assume remote reports eliminate the need for any onsite condition assessment?

05 • Asset program coordinator: No. The package description doesn't establish that, and technical suitability needs the appropriate review.

06 • Maintenance planning lead: Then the tradeoff is different ways of collecting information, not automatically better safety or reliability.

07 • Asset program coordinator: Exactly. We also need to know what each package excludes before comparing lifecycle cost.

08 • Maintenance planning lead: I'll request the exclusions and follow-up responsibilities from both suppliers using the same questions.

09 • Asset program coordinator: Good. Keep the same twelve-asset scope in both responses so the comparison remains meaningful.

10 • Maintenance planning lead: We'll present the verified differences and unresolved suitability questions rather than announce a winner prematurely.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 05 / 06 • SAY IT

Two scenarios to practice

Use only the supplied facts. Prepare for two minutes, speak for one minute, then respond to a follow-up. Switch roles and repeat. For solo study, speak both roles aloud.

Scenario 1 | Asset Management and Maintenance

Two asset options have different purchase prices and maintenance needs. A budget slide compares only the purchase price.

Prepare for two minutes. Speak for 45-60 seconds using the case facts, then respond to your partner's question. Switch roles and repeat without reading the model response.

Partner: You favor one option but have not checked whether the scope is comparable. Ask about one difference, then explain the tradeoff you are willing to accept.

Second round: Your listener focuses only on the lowest price or fastest date. Explain one other relevant comparison criterion.

Model for scenario 1: The initial price is only one part of the comparison. Let's show the assumed maintenance, expected service period, and other relevant lifecycle costs so the decision reflects the full basis of the estimate.

Scenario 2 | A shorter warranty changes the comparison

Two fictional asset quotations cover the same equipment quantity. A has a lower price and one-year warranty; B has a higher price and three-year warranty. Maintenance costs and exact warranty terms are unknown. Compare the available information without choosing a technical solution.

Role A: Procurement analyst: use matching criteria and explain the initial-cost versus stated-duration tradeoff.

Role B: Asset manager: ask which missing terms could affect lifecycle cost.

Possible opening: A has the lower purchase price, while B states a longer warranty period; the detailed terms still need review.

Success checks

- Compare the same equipment scope.
- Avoid equating warranty duration with no maintenance costs.
- Identify missing terms and maintenance information.

Add a complication: The manager calls B maintenance-free for three years based solely on its warranty duration.

Check: facts accurate | meaning clear | tone appropriate | next action or question explicit

Continue scenario 1 with an AI partner.

LESSON 06 / READ AND NOTICE

Emergency Preparedness and Storm Response

Give a handoff that the receiving person can confirm.

SITUATION

A storm-response coordination shift has several requested resources but only some confirmed. The next coordinator needs the distinction.

1. Understand the situation

Identify two confirmed facts, one missing detail, and the person who needs your response. Do not fill gaps with invented facts.

2. Find the words

mutual aid - Assistance provided between organizations under agreed response arrangements.

crew staging - Positioning personnel and resources to prepare for an operational response.

restoration priority - The order in which service-restoration activities are addressed under defined criteria.

emergency response - Coordinated action under established procedures to address an urgent harmful event.

3. Notice the language

State the current situation, relevant background, open task, and receiving role. Ask for acknowledgment or repeat-back of the critical item. Sending a message and transferring responsibility are not always the same thing.

The current status is ...; the outstanding item is

The record shows

Please confirm who has accepted

Compare this wording: Someone should follow up on this.

LESSON 06 / PRACTICE AND PRODUCE

Transfer information and responsibility

4. Check the language

1. Which sentence checks that responsibility has been accepted?
 - A. Please confirm who will complete the outstanding check.
 - B. I mentioned the check in my earlier email.
 - C. The check appears somewhere in the notes.
2. Which response best checks a critical handoff detail?
 - A. I assume all results are final, so we can finish.
 - B. I saw the message, so no clarification is needed.
 - C. So the result is pending and your team will follow up; is that correct?

05 • Conversations

The next three pages contain original fictional conversations for this lesson. Each numbered line is one speaking turn. Read the setting before assigning roles.

LESSON 06 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 1 OF 3

Requested crews are not confirmed crews

Fictional storm-response coordination handoff: four mutual-aid crews were requested, two confirmed, and staging details remain open; no field deployment instructions are supplied.

01 • Outgoing response coordinator: Four mutual-aid crews were requested, but only two are confirmed in the current response record.

02 • Incoming response coordinator: I'll take resource follow-up. Are staging arrangements confirmed for those two accepted crews?

03 • Outgoing response coordinator: Not yet. The record still shows crew staging details pending with the responsible coordination team.

04 • Incoming response coordinator: Then I shouldn't brief management as four crews ready for deployment at the staging location.

05 • Outgoing response coordinator: Correct. Request, confirmation, and staging readiness are separate statuses in this handoff.

06 • Incoming response coordinator: I'll contact the listed coordination team and maintain the distinction in the resource summary.

07 • Outgoing response coordinator: Please leave restoration-priority decisions with the authorized emergency-response process, not assumptions from crew counts.

08 • Incoming response coordinator: Understood. This handoff transfers resource follow-up, not authority to decide field deployment or restoration priorities.

09 • Outgoing response coordinator: Can you confirm the quantities and open item before I finish the shift?

10 • Incoming response coordinator: Four requested, two confirmed, staging pending; I accept the next coordination contact and status update.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 06 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 2 OF 3

Lodging accepted, transport not arranged

Separate fictional storm-logistics case: lodging for ten support staff is confirmed, but transport from the arrival point is only requested.

01 • Storm logistics planner: Lodging for ten support staff is confirmed. Their transport request is still awaiting acceptance.

02 • Incoming logistics lead: I accept transport follow-up. Has anyone told the staff that pickup is already arranged?

03 • Storm logistics planner: The draft says all logistics complete, but it hasn't been sent to them yet.

04 • Incoming logistics lead: I'll correct that before release. Lodging confirmation shouldn't hide an unresolved transport arrangement.

05 • Storm logistics planner: The request reference and receiving contact are linked in the emergency-response coordination record.

06 • Incoming logistics lead: I'll check with that contact and ask who has accepted responsibility for the transport task.

07 • Storm logistics planner: Please don't invent a pickup time while waiting; none is confirmed in our current information.

08 • Incoming logistics lead: Agreed. I'll tell staff what is confirmed and who is checking the remaining arrangement.

09 • Storm logistics planner: So lodging stays confirmed, transport stays requested, and your shift owns the next contact?

10 • Incoming logistics lead: Yes. I'll update the record with verified acceptance or keep the unresolved status explicit.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 06 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 3 OF 3

A resource cancellation needs a receiving owner

Separate fictional coordination case: one previously confirmed support vehicle is withdrawn; a replacement is requested but unconfirmed during shift change.

01 • Outgoing resource officer: One confirmed support vehicle has been withdrawn. A replacement is requested, but not yet accepted.

02 • Incoming resource officer: I'll take replacement follow-up. Does the current emergency-response summary still count the withdrawn vehicle?

03 • Outgoing resource officer: Yes, the summary hasn't been revised since the withdrawal notice arrived during this handoff.

04 • Incoming resource officer: I'll correct that count and keep the replacement request separate from confirmed resources.

05 • Outgoing resource officer: Please preserve the withdrawal notice so the next coordinator can understand the change in availability.

06 • Incoming resource officer: I will. Has an authorized team assessed the effect on the current coordination plan?

07 • Outgoing resource officer: That assessment is still pending. We shouldn't invent a deployment change ourselves from this resource update.

08 • Incoming resource officer: Then I'll request the assessment and identify its status alongside the replacement request.

09 • Outgoing resource officer: Thank you. Please confirm you own both contacts, without calling the vehicle shortage resolved.

10 • Incoming resource officer: Confirmed. I'll coordinate replacement status and the authorized impact review, with both open until verified.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 06 / 06 • SAY IT

Two scenarios to practice

Use only the supplied facts. Prepare for two minutes, speak for one minute, then respond to a follow-up. Switch roles and repeat. For solo study, speak both roles aloud.

Scenario 1 | Emergency Preparedness and Storm Response

A storm-response coordination shift has several requested resources but only some confirmed. The next coordinator needs the distinction.

Prepare for two minutes. Speak for 45-60 seconds using the case facts, then respond to your partner's question. Switch roles and repeat without reading the model response.

Partner: You are taking over the work. Ask what remains open and repeat back the critical status or responsibility. Point out one detail that would be unsafe or misleading to assume.

Second round: The intended recipient cannot take ownership. Keep the status clear and identify the need for an authorized reassignment.

Model for scenario 1: These resources are confirmed; the others are still requested. I've separated their status and contact points in the handoff. Please confirm receipt and update the record when an assignment changes.

Scenario 2 | A staging contact is unavailable

A fictional storm-coordination plan lists a staging contact who has become unavailable. The staging arrangement itself has not been canceled, but no replacement contact has accepted. Hand over the need for an authorized reassignment.

Role A: Outgoing coordinator: distinguish the unavailable contact from the arrangement's unverified status.

Role B: Duty lead: accept the reassignment request and keep current follow-up ownership explicit.

Possible opening: The listed staging contact is unavailable, and we need a confirmed replacement before treating the handoff as accepted.

Success checks

- Avoid assuming acceptance by an unnamed replacement.
- Do not claim staging is canceled without evidence.
- Confirm ownership of the reassignment request.

Add a complication: Someone suggests assuming the named person's colleague has taken over.

Check: facts accurate | meaning clear | tone appropriate | next action or question explicit

Continue scenario 1 with an AI partner.

LESSON 07 / READ AND NOTICE

Customer Programs and Energy Efficiency

Separate observations, assumptions, and conclusions.

SITUATION

An efficiency program reports lower energy use after installation, but weather and occupancy also changed.

1. Understand the situation

Identify two confirmed facts, one missing detail, and the person who needs your response. Do not fill gaps with invented facts.

2. Find the words

incentive - A benefit or consequence intended to encourage particular behavior.

baseline - A defined starting value or agreed reference used to measure change.

demand response - A change in electricity use in response to prices, incentives, or system needs.

measurement and verification - Methods used to assess changes in performance or savings against a defined basis.

3. Notice the language

Say what the evidence shows, identify what is still unknown, and limit the conclusion to that evidence. Words such as 'may', 'suggests', and 'in this sample' are useful when the uncertainty is real. Do not soften an urgent, verified safety concern.

The available evidence shows

This may indicate ..., but

We have not yet established whether

Compare this wording: The pilot proves this will work everywhere.

LESSON 07 / PRACTICE AND PRODUCE

Match certainty to evidence

4. Check the language

1. Which sentence preserves uncertainty about an unconfirmed cause?
 - A. The change must have caused the delay.
 - B. The change definitely caused the delay.
 - C. The change may have contributed to the delay.
2. A result comes from a small pilot in one location. Which phrase accurately limits the claim?
 - A. Across the service, the observed result was ...
 - B. In this pilot, the observed result was ...
 - C. In similar locations, we can now expect the same result ...

05 • Conversations

The next three pages contain original fictional conversations for this lesson. Each numbered line is one speaking turn. Read the setting before assigning roles.

LESSON 07 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 1 OF 3

Lower energy use has several possible explanations

Fictional program evaluation: measured energy use fell after installation, while weather and occupancy also changed; attribution has not been established.

01 • Efficiency program manager: Energy use fell after installation, so the program caused the entire reduction in this building.

02 • Evaluation analyst: The reduction is observed, but weather and occupancy changed too. Attribution remains unresolved.

03 • Efficiency program manager: Could you explain why the before-and-after baseline comparison doesn't settle the question by itself?

04 • Evaluation analyst: It compares different conditions. Measurement and verification needs to address those differences before attributing savings.

05 • Efficiency program manager: Then we can report lower measured use, but not claim every saved unit came from installation.

06 • Evaluation analyst: Exactly. Keep the observation and the causal interpretation separate in the customer-program update.

07 • Efficiency program manager: Should we promise the same reduction to every applicant considering the incentive this month?

08 • Evaluation analyst: No. This incomplete single-building comparison doesn't establish results for other participants or operating conditions.

09 • Efficiency program manager: I'll request the adjusted analysis and label the current result as an observed change only.

10 • Evaluation analyst: Good. That keeps the program message useful without overstating verified savings or individual outcomes.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 07 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 2 OF 3

Enrollment is not demonstrated demand reduction

Separate fictional demand-response pilot: forty businesses enrolled; event participation and measured reductions have not yet been reviewed.

01 • Customer program lead: Forty businesses enrolled in the demand-response pilot. Can we report forty successful reductions?

02 • Measurement specialist: Enrollment is confirmed, but event participation and measured demand changes haven't been reviewed yet.

03 • Customer program lead: I thought signing up showed that each business delivered the expected response during the event.

04 • Measurement specialist: It shows agreement to participate, not what happened during a specific measured event.

05 • Customer program lead: What evidence would the evaluation team need before making a performance statement about those businesses?

06 • Measurement specialist: They need the relevant event data and the agreed baseline method, reviewed for this pilot.

07 • Customer program lead: Could we call the incentive cost money saved while that analysis is still pending?

08 • Measurement specialist: Not from enrollment alone. Program cost and verified savings are different figures with separate evidence.

09 • Customer program lead: I'll celebrate the enrollment milestone while clearly stating that performance verification remains open.

10 • Measurement specialist: That recognizes participation without converting a program-registration count into a measured energy outcome.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 07 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 3 OF 3

A projected saving is not a meter result

Separate fictional efficiency case: a proposal models a 10% saving, but installation has not occurred and no post-installation measurements exist.

01 • Program adviser: The proposal shows ten percent savings. Can the customer newsletter say we achieved that reduction?

02 • Verification coordinator: No. It's a modeled projection before installation, not a result from measured energy use.

03 • Program adviser: Then should we remove it entirely because it isn't yet a verified outcome?

04 • Verification coordinator: You can retain it as a clearly labeled estimate, with the relevant assumptions and scope.

05 • Program adviser: The model uses the proposed operating schedule. That schedule hasn't been confirmed by the customer.

06 • Verification coordinator: Then identify that assumption too. An unconfirmed schedule can affect the interpretation of the projection.

07 • Program adviser: I'll say projected under the model assumptions, not guaranteed savings for this customer's bills.

08 • Verification coordinator: Good. Any later measurement and verification should use the agreed method and actual relevant data.

09 • Program adviser: I'll ask the customer-program team to confirm the schedule before the proposal is finalized.

10 • Verification coordinator: That keeps projected performance, installation status, and measured results distinct throughout the conversation.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 07 / 06 • SAY IT

Two scenarios to practice

Use only the supplied facts. Prepare for two minutes, speak for one minute, then respond to a follow-up. Switch roles and repeat. For solo study, speak both roles aloud.

Scenario 1 | Customer Programs and Energy Efficiency

An efficiency program reports lower energy use after installation, but weather and occupancy also changed.

Prepare for two minutes. Speak for 45-60 seconds using the case facts, then respond to your partner's question. Switch roles and repeat without reading the model response.

Partner: You need to tell a colleague what is known. Ask which part is confirmed and which part is an assumption. Challenge one statement that sounds more certain than the case supports.

Second round: Someone asks for a yes-or-no answer when the evidence supports only a qualified answer. Be concise while preserving the uncertainty.

Model for scenario 1: Energy use fell after installation, but weather and occupancy changed too. I'll describe the measurement basis and remaining uncertainty before attributing the entire reduction to the program.

Scenario 2 | One month is missing from the baseline

A fictional efficiency comparison uses eleven months of baseline records against twelve months after installation. One baseline month is missing, and no adjustment is documented. Discuss what can be claimed and what the evaluation team should check.

Role A: Program analyst: identify the unequal periods and limit the current conclusion.

Role B: Program manager: ask how to describe the result without claiming verified annual savings.

Possible opening: The comparison uses different period lengths, so it doesn't yet establish verified annual savings.

Success checks

- Identify the missing month rather than invent its value.
- Avoid claiming annual savings from the unequal comparison.
- Request an appropriate evaluation of the data gap.

Add a complication: The manager suggests treating the missing month as zero use.

Check: facts accurate | meaning clear | tone appropriate | next action or question explicit

Continue scenario 1 with an AI partner.

LESSON 08 / READ AND NOTICE

Executive Reliability and Investment Updates

Explain a useful distinction in plain English.

SITUATION

A reliability presentation lists SAIDI and SAIFI without explanations. Community representatives need to understand the distinction.

1. Understand the situation

Identify two confirmed facts, one missing detail, and the person who needs your response. Do not fill gaps with invented facts.

2. Find the words

SAIDI - System Average Interruption Duration Index: average interruption duration per customer under a stated reporting basis.

SAIFI - System Average Interruption Frequency Index: average number of interruptions per customer under a stated reporting basis.

vegetation management - Managing trees and other vegetation near utility assets under applicable operational and environmental requirements.

capital plan - A plan for investment in long-lived assets or major projects.

3. Notice the language

Start with the reader's question. Explain one unfamiliar term with familiar words, then give a relevant example or contrast. Check understanding without asking only 'Do you understand?'.

In this context, ... means

The difference is that

How would you explain that distinction to a colleague?

Compare this wording: We need to operationalize the implementation.

LESSON 08 / PRACTICE AND PRODUCE

Make a complex point clear

4. Check the language

1. Which sentence explains 'backlog' rather than repeating it?
 - A. The backlog is the maximum work the team can finish in a period.
 - B. The backlog is the work still waiting to be completed.
 - C. The backlog is the work completed during the last period.
2. Which follow-up best checks whether your explanation was clear?
 - A. How would you describe the next step in your own words?
 - B. Would you like me to repeat the explanation?
 - C. Was the explanation detailed enough for you?

05 • Conversations

The next three pages contain original fictional conversations for this lesson. Each numbered line is one speaking turn. Read the setting before assigning roles.

LESSON 08 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 1 OF 3

Duration and frequency answer different questions

Fictional community briefing: a slide lists SAIDI and SAIFI without definitions; values and calculation boundaries are not supplied.

01 • Community liaison: The slide lists SAIDI and SAIFI, but community representatives won't know those labels.

02 • Reliability analyst: SAIDI averages accumulated interruption time per customer over the reporting period; SAIFI averages interruption counts per customer over that period.

03 • Community liaison: So SAIDI means total interruption time per customer, not average time per individual outage?

04 • Reliability analyst: Correct. SAIFI means the number of interruptions per customer; both refer to the defined reporting period.

05 • Community liaison: Could fewer interruptions per customer still accompany more accumulated interruption time per customer?

06 • Reliability analyst: Yes. Improvement in one measure doesn't establish improvement in the other over the same period.

07 • Community liaison: I'll avoid presenting either average as a description of every household's personal experience.

08 • Reliability analyst: Good. Individual customers can experience different interruption counts and accumulated time from those averages.

09 • Community liaison: I'll request the period, population, and event-inclusion rules before discussing our capital plan.

10 • Reliability analyst: Those boundaries will help the community interpret both measures consistently in the investment discussion.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 08 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 2 OF 3

Capital spending is not a reliability result

Separate fictional executive update: a vegetation-management investment is approved, but implementation and reliability results have not been evaluated.

01 • Executive briefing writer: The capital plan approves the vegetation-management investment. Can I say reliability has already improved?

02 • Asset strategy manager: Approval is a funding decision, not a measured reliability outcome from implemented work.

03 • Executive briefing writer: How should I explain that distinction without making the investment approval sound insignificant?

04 • Asset strategy manager: Say funding is approved for the proposed work, while delivery and outcome evaluation remain separate stages.

05 • Executive briefing writer: Then SAIDI and SAIFI aren't budget measures, even if we discuss them on the same slide?

06 • Asset strategy manager: Correct. They summarize accumulated interruption time and counts per customer over the reporting period, not capital spending.

07 • Executive briefing writer: Could the slide say the plan is intended to improve reliability, with results still to be assessed?

08 • Asset strategy manager: Yes, provided that reflects the plan's stated purpose and doesn't guarantee a particular improvement.

09 • Executive briefing writer: I'll separate the funding milestone, implementation status, and future performance evidence in the briefing.

10 • Asset strategy manager: Good. Community readers can then see what the approval means and what it doesn't yet establish.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 08 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 3 OF 3

An average can hide different customer experiences

Separate fictional reliability discussion: illustrative system-wide accumulated interruption time per customer decreases over a defined reporting period, while the report has not yet been broken down by service area.

01 • Community engagement manager: System-wide interruption time per customer decreased. Did every service area experience less total interruption time?

02 • Reliability reporting lead: No. A system average doesn't establish what happened in each area or for each customer.

03 • Community engagement manager: Could you explain that in familiar language for the community meeting opening remarks?

04 • Reliability reporting lead: Combining many experiences produces one summary. Some areas may differ from that overall result.

05 • Community engagement manager: We haven't reviewed the area breakdown, so we can't identify which areas improved yet.

06 • Reliability reporting lead: Exactly. Keep the system-level claim within the report's verified scope and request the relevant breakdown.

07 • Community engagement manager: Would showing SAIFI instead solve the problem of different individual experiences across the system?

08 • Reliability reporting lead: No. Frequency is a different measure, but an average still doesn't describe every individual experience.

09 • Community engagement manager: I'll explain the aggregate result and acknowledge that area-specific questions need additional evidence.

10 • Reliability reporting lead: That supports honest risk and investment communication without overstating what one summary statistic can tell us.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 08 / 06 • SAY IT

Two scenarios to practice

Use only the supplied facts. Prepare for two minutes, speak for one minute, then respond to a follow-up. Switch roles and repeat. For solo study, speak both roles aloud.

Scenario 1 | Executive Reliability and Investment Updates

A reliability presentation lists SAIDI and SAIFI without explanations. Community representatives need to understand the distinction.

Prepare for two minutes. Speak for 45-60 seconds using the case facts, then respond to your partner's question. Switch roles and repeat without reading the model response.

Partner: You are unfamiliar with one technical term in the case. Ask for a plain-English explanation and then paraphrase it. Do not pretend to understand a term you cannot explain.

Second round: Your listener is new to this field. Replace two specialist expressions with clear explanations without changing the meaning.

Model for scenario 1: One measure summarizes average interruption duration and the other interruption frequency for the defined customer group. I'll explain both, state the reporting basis, and show what changed over the period.

Scenario 2 | Two reports exclude different events

Two fictional reliability slides cover the same year, but one includes a major storm and the other excludes it. Their accumulated interruption times per customer over that year differ. Explain why the comparison needs matching boundaries before attributing a performance change.

Role A: Reliability analyst: explain the difference in included events using plain English.

Role B: Executive presenter: ask how to label the slides and compare them fairly.

Possible opening: These figures include different events, so the difference isn't automatically a change in underlying performance.

Success checks

- Identify the different event boundaries.
- Avoid attributing the difference to improvement without analysis.
- Agree clear labels and a consistent comparison.

Add a complication: The presenter wants to use only the lower number without disclosing the exclusion.

Check: facts accurate | meaning clear | tone appropriate | next action or question explicit

Continue scenario 1 with an AI partner.

Answer workshop

Try the tasks first. The model is one acceptable response to scenario 1, not a script to memorize. Assess your spoken version using the four criteria at the end.

01 | Grid Reliability and Outage Response

Editing example: Three checks are complete; two remain open and are being reviewed.

The revision gives observable progress. A positive label alone does not tell the reader what is complete or still needed.

Check 1: C - The team has completed the review.

A: 'Is completing' presents the work as in progress.

B: 'Plans to complete' describes an intention, not completion.

C: 'Has completed' states that the action is finished.

Check 2: B - Delivery is planned for Friday; the carrier has not confirmed it.

A: A plan cannot prove a future arrival time.

B: This explicitly labels the date as planned and identifies the missing confirmation.

C: A plan does not establish carrier confirmation.

Model response: The affected area is identified, but restoration timing is still being assessed. I'll state what is confirmed and when customers should expect the next update rather than promise an unverified time.

Case check: underline the confirmed information and circle a limitation, question, or next step in the response.

02 | Safety, Field Work, and Switching

Editing example: Could you explain what this means?

After an introductory phrase such as 'Could you explain', the embedded question uses statement word order: "what this means".

Check 1: B - Could you confirm when the review starts?

A: Place the subject 'the review' before 'starts'.

B: The embedded question uses subject then verb: "the review starts".

C: Remove 'does' and use statement word order after 'confirm'.

Check 2: A - Has the report been approved, or is it ready for review?

A: This question distinguishes two meanings of 'ready' that affect the next action.

B: This asks about delivery timing, not whether approval has happened.

C: This asks about the presenter, not the report's approval status.

Model response: The equipment identifiers do not match. Please have the authorized team resolve the discrepancy using the approved procedure. I will repeat the identifiers clearly to confirm that we are discussing the same equipment.

Case check: underline the confirmed information and circle a limitation, question, or next step in the response.

03 | Regulatory Affairs and Rate Cases

Editing example: We need to put the plan into practice.

The revised sentence names the action in familiar words. Specialist vocabulary is useful when it adds precision, but repeating abstract nouns can hide the meaning.

Check 1: A - The backlog is the work still waiting to be completed.

A: This gives the meaning in familiar words.

B: Completed work is different from work still waiting.

C: This describes capacity, not the work waiting to be completed.

Check 2: C - How would you describe the next step in your own words?

A: Offering repetition may help, but it does not show how the listener understood the next step.

B: This invites an opinion on detail, not a demonstration of understanding.

C: An open request lets the listener show their understanding.

Model response: The notice describes a proposed adjustment, not a change already in effect. Let me show you the stated review process and where to find the current applicable tariff information.

Case check: underline the confirmed information and circle a limitation, question, or next step in the response.

04 | Renewables Integration and Interconnection

Editing example: The pilot worked in the tested setting; performance elsewhere remains untested.

The revision states the finding and its scope. It avoids turning limited evidence into a universal claim.

Check 1: C - The change may have contributed to the delay.

A: 'Must have' expresses a strong inference that the evidence may not support.

B: 'Definitely' presents the cause as certain.

C: 'May have contributed' presents a possibility without claiming the cause is established.

Check 2: B - In this pilot, the observed result was ...

A: A pilot in one location does not establish a service-wide observation.

B: This locates the finding in the setting actually studied.

C: Similarity alone does not establish that the result will transfer.

Model response: The application has been submitted, but the reviews are still open. I'll describe the current stage and remaining steps without implying that connection has already been authorized.

Case check: underline the confirmed information and circle a limitation, question, or next step in the response.

05 | Asset Management and Maintenance

Editing example: This option is better on cost, but slower to deliver.

'Better' already has comparative meaning, so it does not need 'more'. Naming the criterion and tradeoff makes the comparison useful.

Check 1: B - Option A is faster, whereas option B costs less.

A: 'So' implies one fact causes the other.

B: 'Whereas' marks a contrast between two options.

C: 'Because' claims a causal connection that is not given.

Check 2: A - An increase of one percentage point.

A: Subtracting 6% from 7% gives one percentage point. The relative increase is about 16.7%.

B: A one-percent relative increase on 6% would be 6.06%, not 7%.

C: The new rate is 7%; the difference between the rates is one percentage point.

Model response: The initial price is only one part of the comparison. Let's show the assumed maintenance, expected service period, and other relevant lifecycle costs so the decision reflects the full basis of the estimate.

Case check: underline the confirmed information and circle a limitation, question, or next step in the response.

06 | Emergency Preparedness and Storm Response

Editing example: Please confirm which team has accepted the follow-up task.

The revised sentence asks for an identifiable receiving team instead of leaving responsibility with an unspecified 'someone'.

Check 1: A - Please confirm who will complete the outstanding check.

A: It asks for an identifiable person or team responsible for the task.

B: Mentioning a task does not show that anyone accepted it.

C: A written record alone does not identify who will act.

Check 2: C - So the result is pending and your team will follow up; is that correct?

A: It changes pending information into a final result.

B: Receiving a message is not the same as confirming its meaning.

C: This repeats the status and responsibility and invites correction.

Model response: These resources are confirmed; the others are still requested. I've separated their status and contact points in the handoff. Please confirm receipt and update the record when an assignment changes.

Case check: underline the confirmed information and circle a limitation, question, or next step in the response.

07 | Customer Programs and Energy Efficiency

Editing example: The pilot worked in the tested setting; performance elsewhere remains untested.

The revision states the finding and its scope. It avoids turning limited evidence into a universal claim.

Check 1: C - The change may have contributed to the delay.

A: 'Must have' expresses a strong inference that the evidence may not support.

B: 'Definitely' presents the cause as certain.

C: 'May have contributed' presents a possibility without claiming the cause is established.

Check 2: B - In this pilot, the observed result was ...

A: A pilot in one location does not establish a service-wide observation.

B: This locates the finding in the setting actually studied.

C: Similarity alone does not establish that the result will transfer.

Model response: Energy use fell after installation, but weather and occupancy changed too. I'll describe the measurement basis and remaining uncertainty before attributing the entire reduction to the program.

Case check: underline the confirmed information and circle a limitation, question, or next step in the response.

08 | Executive Reliability and Investment Updates

Editing example: We need to put the plan into practice.

The revised sentence names the action in familiar words. Specialist vocabulary is useful when it adds precision, but repeating abstract nouns can hide the meaning.

Check 1: B - The backlog is the work still waiting to be completed.

A: This describes capacity, not the work waiting to be completed.

B: This gives the meaning in familiar words.

C: Completed work is different from work still waiting.

Check 2: A - How would you describe the next step in your own words?

A: An open request lets the listener show their understanding.

B: Offering repetition may help, but it does not show how the listener understood the next step.

C: This invites an opinion on detail, not a demonstration of understanding.

Model response: One measure summarizes average interruption duration and the other interruption frequency for the defined customer group. I'll explain both, state the reporting basis, and show what changed over the period.

Case check: underline the confirmed information and circle a limitation, question, or next step in the response.

Give feedback that helps

Score each criterion 0, 1, or 2. This is a practice rubric, not a professional qualification or CEFR test. Do not award or remove points for a particular accent.

Meaning and accuracy

Keeps the case facts accurate; clearly separates confirmed and unknown information.

Clarity and language

Uses understandable sentences and explains specialist terms when the listener needs it.

Interaction and tone

Responds to the other person's question, checks understanding, and uses an appropriate tone.

Task completion

Makes the requested action or unresolved question clear without inventing authority or facts.

Use the same scale for each criterion

0 - Not yet: The reader or listener cannot yet recover the intended meaning or action.

1 - With support: The message works after a prompt, clarification, or revision.

2 - Independently: The message is clear and accurate without a prompt.

Feedback sequence

First, identify a successful phrase. Next, identify one point where meaning or accuracy needs work. Offer one useful language correction, allow a repeat, and compare the two attempts. A total out of eight describes this performance only; do not translate it into a proficiency level.

Final challenge

Choose a case not rehearsed today. The learner gives a one-minute response, answers two follow-up questions, and writes a 70-110 word message. Add the lesson's second-round challenge. Compare the result with an earlier attempt using the four criteria.

Use the language responsibly

These cases practice communication. Actual equipment, construction, and safety work follows approved procedures and authorized specialist decisions.

Meaning before performance

Use specialist terms only when they help the listener. Explain unfamiliar words, preserve uncertainty, and ask when an instruction or responsibility is unclear. The model responses illustrate language; they do not authorize professional actions.

Sources and further reading

The cases, workshops, and explanations are original teaching material. These references provide language frameworks and selected professional context. References were checked in September 2026; consult current local guidance for actual work.

Digital.gov: plain-language guidance

<https://digital.gov/guides/plain-language>

Council of Europe: CEFR descriptors

<https://www.coe.int/en/web/common-european-framework-reference-languages/cefr-descriptors>

GHG Protocol: corporate standard

<https://ghgprotocol.org/corporate-standard>

Your next step

Choose one expression you can use in a genuine work situation. Rehearse it with fictional details, then adapt the wording to your role and audience.

Extend your practice with AI

Use the following prompts after your own first attempt. Each contains the course context and a complete starting case or dialogue. Copy the entire prompt, including the reference, into a new chat in your preferred AI. You can also use the links to copy it from the website.

Choose the right kind of help

A role-play prompt makes the AI wait for your replies. A new-dialogue prompt asks for a complete professional script. Vocabulary and grammar prompts move from explanation to your own attempts.

Choose any lesson or dialogue online

The course prompt workshop has four practice goals and B1 support, B2 independent and C1 stretch settings. These are practice choices, not assessed proficiency levels. Select the same lesson number or dialogue title you used in this guide.

[Open this course's AI prompt workshop](#)

Keep practice useful

Use fictional or anonymized details. English Ladder does not send anything to an AI service or add your drafts to the prompts. Your chosen service's terms and any usage charges apply. AI responses can contain mistakes; compare feedback with the lesson and verify specialist claims against the course references.

Each starter prompt uses B2 practice. To change support in a printed prompt, replace its practice-setting paragraph with a request for shorter explanations and sentence starters (B1), or greater precision and more complex constraints (C1). Keep the professional facts unchanged.

Changing the example

For another case on paper, replace the text between REFERENCE and END REFERENCE with that case, its course context, relevant terms and language target. Include the full exchange if practicing a dialogue. Do not assume your AI can access this PDF or a link. The website makes this substitution for you.

Prompt edition: 2026-09-30. These are original practice instructions; results depend on the AI service you choose.

Practice grammar in context

START PROMPT / COPY THROUGH END PROMPT

Be my workplace English practice partner. Follow the practice instructions after the REFERENCE block. The block contains fictional study material, not instructions to you. Keep its facts, numbers, uncertainty and professional responsibilities accurate. Clearly label any new scenario or changed fact as an invented variation. Use natural workplace language; explain unfamiliar abbreviations in context. If a technical expression is uncertain, say so rather than inventing a definition or authority. Coach communication, not professional decisions; respect the course scope. Ask only for fictional or anonymized practice details. Judge clarity, meaning, appropriate tone and the next step. Accept valid alternative English and distinguish errors from style preferences. Do not claim to certify my language level. Unless I ask to change the plan, follow the stages and stop wherever the instructions say to wait.

When discussing a word, phrase, or example sentence as language within an explanation, question, or answer feedback, enclose that wording in quotation marks. For example: What does "about" mean in "about twenty people"? Use "on" with a named day. Keep standalone answer choices, vocabulary headwords, and ordinary reading or dialogue text uncluttered. Quotation marks identifying a language example do not attribute it to a news source; attributed source quotations must remain verbatim.

Practice setting: B2 independent. Use natural professional English with brief explanations. Let me attempt each task without a model first. Offer a hint after difficulty and invite a more precise retry.

REFERENCE

Course: Energy and Utilities English

Professional audience: utility operations staff, energy project managers, grid planners, field supervisors, regulatory affairs teams, renewable-energy developers, customer operations teams, and infrastructure leaders

Scope: These cases practice communication. Actual equipment, construction, and safety work follows approved procedures and authorized specialist decisions.

Lesson 01: Grid Reliability and Outage Response

Original fictional case: An outage update lists an affected area but the restoration estimate is still under assessment. A draft message gives a firm time.

Language workshop: Give a useful status update

Communication goal: Distinguish completed work from pending work and explain its impact.

Language guidance: Lead with the current state, then the important change or open item. Use completed-action language only for completed work. Add a next update point when it is known; do not invent a date to make the message sound complete.

Useful frames (complete the gaps with case facts): We have completed ...; ... remains open. / As of ..., the status is / The next update will cover

Vocabulary: reliability: The ability to perform an intended function consistently under stated conditions over time. / feeder: An electrical distribution circuit carrying power to a local service area. / restoration: Returning a disrupted service to operation. / critical customer: A customer whose service needs receive particular operational attention under defined criteria.

Speaking task: Prepare for two minutes. Speak for 45-60 seconds using the case facts, then respond to your partner's question. Switch roles and repeat without reading the model response.

Partner: You need to brief someone who has only one minute. Ask what is complete, what is open, and which open item affects the next action.

Writing task: Write a 70-110 word message for the person who needs to act on this case. State the purpose, preserve the relevant facts, and make the next action or unresolved question clear. Use a subject line and an appropriate opening. Do not invent a deadline, finding, or approval.

Optional second-round challenge: The listener asks you to reduce the update to two sentences. Preserve the most important completed and pending items.

Model for comparison AFTER my attempt, not a response to give me first: The affected area is identified, but restoration timing is still being assessed. I'll state what is confirmed and when customers should expect the next update rather than promise an unverified time.

END REFERENCE

TASK: Grammar that changes the meaning

1. For a lesson, use its language workshop as the focus. For a dialogue, quote one actual sentence and select one useful grammar feature from it, such as question word order, tense, modality, conditionals or clause linking. Explain in no more than 90 words how this feature helps the speakers do their work. Keep the grammar target narrow.
2. Give two short contrasting sentences using this workplace context. Explain the difference in time, certainty, condition or politeness. Label invented examples and preserve the distinction between possible, planned and confirmed events. Describe context-dependent choices as choices, not universal rules.
3. Give me one editing or sentence-building task using a known case fact. Do not copy the supplied editing example or reveal its answer. Ask me to explain my intended meaning. Stop and wait.
4. After I answer, quote my wording, identify at most two issues, and give a brief explanation and one hint. Ask me to revise before offering a full corrected version. Then accept any accurate, natural alternative that serves the purpose.
5. Continue with two new tasks, one at a time: first guided, then an original response without a sentence frame. End with a two-sentence workplace message using the target feature and a compact self-check. Do not replace this sequence with a worksheet and answer key.

END PROMPT

Copy this prompt online or choose another lesson and support level